LARKSPUR & CO.

FOR SOLE TRADERS, MAKERS & SIDE HUSTLERS

The UK Bookkeeping Kit

Simple monthly income and expense logs, mileage, invoices, a tax pot, summaries and a Self Assessment checklist, with UK dates and figures.

18 pages · UK tax year · Print at home



A record-keeping tool, not tax advice. Always check GOV.UK or ask an accountant.

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START HERE

Simple books, less stress

Keeping records doesn't have to be complicated. Ten minutes a week with these pages, and your Self Assessment (or your accountant's bill) gets a lot easier.

INSIDE

- [ ] Key UK dates and figures
- [ ] Business details page
- [ ] Monthly income and expenses logs
- [ ] Expense categories made simple
- [ ] Mileage and working from home
- [ ] Invoices and unpaid invoices
- [ ] Monthly, quarterly and annual summaries
- [ ] Tax pot calculator
- [ ] Self Assessment checklist
- [ ] Equipment log and weekly money routine

THE TEN-MINUTE WEEKLY ROUTINE

1. Log this week's income.
2. Log expenses and file the receipts.
3. Log business miles.
4. Chase any unpaid invoices.
5. Move money into your tax pot.

Please note: this kit helps you keep organised records. It isn't tax or accounting advice. Tax rules, rates and thresholds change, so check GOV.UK or speak to an accountant about your own situation.

NOTES

KNOW THE BASICS

Key UK dates & figures

For sole traders using Self Assessment. Check GOV.UK each year for any changes.

KEY DATES

Tax year runs	6 April to 5 April
Register for Self Assessment	By 5 October after the tax year you started
Paper tax return deadline	31 October
Online tax return deadline	31 January
Pay tax owed (balancing payment)	31 January
Payments on account (if they apply)	31 January and 31 July

USEFUL FIGURES (2026/27)

Trading allowance	£1,000 of gross trading income
VAT registration threshold	£90,000 turnover in any 12 months
Simplified mileage (cars and vans)	45p a mile for the first 10,000, then 25p
Working from home flat rate	£10, £18 or £26 a month (25–50, 51–100, 101+ hours)

MAKING TAX DIGITAL FOR INCOME TAX

HMRC is moving sole traders and landlords to digital records and quarterly updates. It started in April 2026 for qualifying income over £50,000, is due to apply from April 2027 for income over £30,000, and is planned for income over £20,000 from April 2028. If it applies to you, you'll need compatible software, but these pages still help you keep on top of your numbers.

MY NOTES FOR THIS TAX YEAR

BUSINESS DETAILS

My business details

Keep these together. Never write passwords here.

BUSINESS

Business name _____

What I do _____

Start date _____

Trading as _____

HMRC

UTR (Unique Taxpayer Reference) _____

National Insurance number _____

VAT number (if registered) _____

Self Assessment registered on _____

BANK

Business bank _____

Account name _____

Accounting software _____

CONTACTS

Accountant _____

Phone _____

Insurer _____

Policy number _____

NOTES

KNOW THE BASICS

Expense categories made simple

Allowable expenses are costs you have "wholly and exclusively" for your business. These categories match the ones on the Self Assessment form.

Cost of goods / materials
Stock, materials and things you buy to resell.

Car, van & travel
Fuel, repairs, parking, train fares (or use simplified mileage instead).

Wages & staff
Staff wages, subcontractors, pensions.

Rent, rates, power & insurance
Business premises costs and business insurance.

Repairs & maintenance
Repairs to business equipment and property.

Phone, internet, stationery & office
Business phone, broadband, postage, printing, software.

Advertising & marketing
Ads, website, business cards, marketplace promoted listings.

Bank & card charges
Business bank charges, card fees, payment processing fees.

Accountancy & legal fees
Accountant's fees, professional fees.

Other allowable costs
Anything else allowable. Check GOV.UK if unsure.

NOTES

MONTHLY RECORDS

Monthly income log

Print one for each month.

Month _____ Tax year _____

DATE	CUSTOMER / PLATFORM	DESCRIPTION	INVOICE NO.	AMOUNT £	PAID HOW

Total income this month £ Carry to the monthly summary

MONTHLY RECORDS

Monthly expenses log

Write the category number (from the categories page) next to each one.

Month _____ Tax year _____

DATE	SUPPLIER	WHAT	CAT. NO.	AMOUNT £	RECEIPT?

Total expenses this month £ Carry to the monthly summary

MONTHLY RECORDS

Mileage log

Business journeys only (not your normal commute). Record each trip.

Month _____ Vehicle _____

DATE	FROM	TO	PURPOSE	MILES

Total business miles _____ × rate _____ = £ _____

MONTHLY RECORDS

Working from home log

If you use the flat rate, record the hours you work from home each month.

MONTH	HOURS WORKED AT HOME	FLAT RATE BAND	£
Apr			
May			
Jun			
Jul			
Aug			
Sep			
Oct			
Nov			
Dec			
Jan			
Feb			
Mar			
Total			

Flat rates (check GOV.UK): 25–50 hours £10, 51–100 hours £18, 101+ hours £26 per month. You can't use the flat rate and also claim the same household costs separately.

NOTES

INVOICES

Invoice log

Number your invoices in order and track when they're paid.

INVOICE NO.	DATE SENT	CUSTOMER	AMOUNT £	DUE	PAID ON

INVOICES

Unpaid invoice chaser

A polite nudge usually works. Track every reminder.

CUSTOMER	INVOICE	£	DUE	1ST REMINDER	2ND REMINDER	PAID

REMINDER WORDING

"Hi [name], I hope you're well. Just a friendly reminder that invoice [number] for £[amount] was due on [date]. I've attached it again for you. Please let me know if you have any questions. Thank you!"

NOTES

SUMMARIES

Monthly summary

Fill in at the end of each month from your logs.

MONTH	INCOME £	EXPENSES £	PROFIT £	MILES	TAX POT £
Apr					
May					
Jun					
Jul					
Aug					
Sep					
Oct					
Nov					
Dec					
Jan					
Feb					
Mar					
Total					

NOTES

SUMMARIES

Quarterly summary

Useful for Making Tax Digital updates, or just a check-in every three months.

QUARTER 1: 6 APR – 5 JUL

Income £ _____ Expenses £ _____ Profit £ _____

Submitted / checked on _____ Notes _____

QUARTER 2: 6 JUL – 5 OCT

Income £ _____ Expenses £ _____ Profit £ _____

Submitted / checked on _____ Notes _____

QUARTER 3: 6 OCT – 5 JAN

Income £ _____ Expenses £ _____ Profit £ _____

Submitted / checked on _____ Notes _____

QUARTER 4: 6 JAN – 5 APR

Income £ _____ Expenses £ _____ Profit £ _____

Submitted / checked on _____ Notes _____

NOTES

SUMMARIES

Annual summary

Your year at a glance, ready for your tax return or accountant.

Tax year _____

INCOME

Total sales / turnover £ _____

Other business income £ _____

Total income £ _____

EXPENSES BY CATEGORY

1. Cost of goods / materials _____
2. Car, van & travel _____
3. Wages & staff _____
4. Rent, rates, power & insurance _____
5. Repairs & maintenance _____
6. Phone, internet, stationery & office _____
7. Advertising & marketing _____
8. Bank & card charges _____
9. Accountancy & legal fees _____
10. Other allowable costs _____

Total expenses £ _____

Profit (income - expenses) £ _____

NOTES

TAX

Tax pot calculator

Set money aside as you go, so January isn't a shock. Many people save a fixed percentage of every payment.

MY SAVINGS RULE

I save _____ % of every payment into _____ account _____

Not sure what percentage? An accountant can help you work it out from your expected profit.

DATE	PAYMENT RECEIVED £	% SAVED	AMOUNT SAVED £	POT TOTAL £

TAX

Self Assessment checklist

Work through this before your tax return.

GATHER

- [ ] Annual summary completed
- [ ] Total income and expenses
- [ ] Mileage total
- [ ] Working from home total
- [ ] Equipment bought this year
- [ ] Bank statements

OTHER INCOME

- [ ] Employment income (P60)
- [ ] Savings interest
- [ ] Rental income
- [ ] Pension contributions
- [ ] Gift Aid donations
- [ ] Student loan details

DO IT

- [ ] Log in to HMRC online account
- [ ] Complete the return
- [ ] Check every figure
- [ ] Submit before 31 January
- [ ] Pay tax owed by 31 January
- [ ] Note any payments on account

AFTER

- [ ] Save a copy of the return
- [ ] Keep records for at least 5 years after the 31 January deadline
- [ ] Start next year's folder
- [ ] Celebrate!

NOTES

RECORDS

Equipment & assets log

Bigger items you buy for the business, like a laptop, camera or sewing machine.

DATE BOUGHT	ITEM	SUPPLIER	COST £	BUSINESS USE %	NOTES

NOTES

RECORDS

Receipt habits

Good habits mean you never lose a receipt (or a tax deduction) again.

DAILY

- [ ] Photograph paper receipts straight away
- [ ] Forward email receipts to one folder
- [ ] Put paper receipts in this month's envelope

WEEKLY

- [ ] Match receipts to the expenses log
- [ ] Write the category number on each
- [ ] Back up photos to the cloud

MONTHLY

- [ ] Check bank statement against logs
- [ ] File the month's envelope
- [ ] Fill in the monthly summary

MY SYSTEM

- [ ] Folder / app I use:
- [ ] Where paper receipts go:
- [ ] Backup:

NOTES